

Surajkund Crafts Mela

BACK WITH A BANG!



The 35th edition of the Surajkund International Crafts Mela, held from March 19th to April 4th, 2022, saw participation from countries around the world and huge footfalls.

It all began in 1987 when Haryana Tourism took a call to preserve the languishing arts and crafts of India by organising a Crafts Mela at Surajkund Lake in Faridabad. It was an earnest effort by the Surajkund Mela Authority & Haryana Tourism to provide a platform for craftspersons and weavers to directly market their wares to customers by eliminating the middleman. The mela was a resounding success and has been held every year since, barring 2021 when it had to be cancelled because of COVID-19. Over the years the popular mela has gone from strength to strength. With over a million visitors on average, it is the largest crafts fair in the world.

In 2013, the mela was upgraded to an international level and in 2015, a record number of 20 countries participated with Lebanon as the Partner Nation and Chhattisgarh as the Theme State. The mela has only grown bigger and better since. This year marked the 35th edition of the crafts mela.

Traditionally always held in the first fortnight of February, this year, because of COVID, the mela was postponed to March 19th to April 4th, 2022. "We took the decision to hold the mela only 15 days before the inauguration date. Within that time frame we were able to rope in more than 30 countries," says Neeraj Chadha, Managing Director, Haryana Tourism. This year the Partner Nation was Uzbekistan and the Partner State was Jammu & Kashmir.

On the conducting of the mela after a gap, Chadha explains: "It is very important for the Government of Haryana to have this mela. After two years,